

Leave and Time-Off Policy

This policy sets the enterprise standard for planned leave, unscheduled absence reporting, approvals, workforce coverage, and the records required for compliant payroll and attendance management.

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1.0 Purpose

This policy exists so employees can take time away from work in a predictable, fair, and well-documented manner without creating avoidable service disruption for customers or internal teams. A production-grade knowledge base should answer not only whether leave is available, but also how the process is executed, what approvals are required, and what records support compliance and payroll accuracy.

The document aligns People Operations, line managers, and employees on a shared operating model. It clarifies planning expectations, defines same-day reporting requirements for unplanned absence, and explains how exceptions are handled when legal obligations, business continuity needs, or employee health concerns require additional coordination.

2.0 Scope

The policy applies to full-time and part-time employees across the company. Country-specific annexes may provide additional entitlements or legal protections, but the workflow in this document remains the default operating model unless local HR guidance explicitly overrides it.

The policy covers annual leave, sick leave, personal leave, bereavement leave, unpaid leave, and manager-approved short absences recorded through the HR information system. It also governs the handoff, scheduling, calendar management, and approval documentation that accompany leave requests.

- Covers leave request submission, approval timing, absence recording, and handoff expectations.
- Applies to remote, hybrid, and office-based employees unless local law requires different handling.
- Does not replace statutory leave obligations, medical accommodation processes, or protected leave rules.

3.0 Responsibilities

The responsibilities below define who must act, approve, review, and maintain records so the process can be executed consistently across teams and audit periods.

3.1 Employees

- Plan foreseeable leave early enough for workload coverage to be arranged and documented.
- Submit complete requests in the HRIS with dates, leave type, and a concise work handoff summary.
- Notify the manager promptly for same-day illness or emergency absence and update the system when able.

3.2 Managers

- Review requests consistently, balance fairness with business continuity, and respond within the defined service level.
- Ensure critical customer deliverables, approvals, and on-call coverage are handed off before leave begins.
- Escalate complex or potentially inconsistent decisions to People Operations before rejecting a request.

3.3 People Operations

- Maintain policy interpretation, local annex guidance, and audit-ready leave records.
- Support exceptions involving extended leave, statutory obligations, or repeated attendance issues.
- Monitor trends, carryover usage, and policy adherence across departments.

4.0 Leave Categories

Annual leave is intended for planned rest, personal commitments, and longer breaks from work. Teams are expected to coordinate around known peak periods such as launches, quarter-close activities, or audit windows, but vacation planning should remain practical and employee-friendly rather than restrictive by default.

Sick leave is intended for an employee's illness, recovery, medical consultation, or the short-term care of an immediate dependent where local policy permits. Managers should prioritize employee well-being and should not ask an unwell employee to continue working except for a brief voluntary handoff when necessary to prevent active operational risk.

4.1 Annual Leave Controls

Annual leave balances accrue according to contract terms and are displayed in the HRIS. Employees should avoid relying on informal approvals in chat or email because payroll, attendance, and manager visibility depend on the request being formally recorded in the system.

- Requests for one or two days should normally be submitted at least three business days in advance.
- Requests for three or more consecutive days should normally be submitted at least ten business days in advance.
- Year-end carryover is governed by local terms and reviewed by People Operations each December.

4.2 Sick, Personal, and Unpaid Leave

Unplanned leave must be reported as early as possible on the day of absence so workload can be reassigned responsibly. Extended unpaid leave requires a documented business and HR review because payroll, benefits, and statutory implications may apply.

- Medical documentation may be requested where legally allowed for repeated or extended absence.
- Sensitive medical details should be shared only with People Operations when documentation is required.
- Unpaid leave is not final until both manager and HR approval are recorded.

5.0 Request and Approval Workflow

The leave workflow is designed to create a single source of truth for staffing, payroll, and employee scheduling. Email or chat can be used for early coordination, but the HRIS record is the authoritative approval trail and must reflect the final dates, leave category, and any exception approval.

- Employee submits request with dates, leave type, and coverage notes.
- Manager validates business impact, overlapping leave, and required handoffs within two business days.
- People Operations reviews extended leave, policy exceptions, and local legal implications where applicable.
- Approved leave syncs with the team calendar and becomes part of attendance reporting.

6.0 Coverage Planning and Exception Handling

Leave planning should not depend on tribal knowledge. Before extended time away, employees should identify active tasks, pending approvals, customer commitments, and escalation contacts so another team member can manage urgent items without recreating context under pressure.

Managers should not deny leave simply because planning was not done early. Instead, they should work with the employee to resolve coverage gaps, escalate real conflicts, and document the reason for any exception decision so the same standard can be applied consistently across the team.

- Use a written handoff for high-risk tasks, customer deadlines, and approval dependencies.
- Escalate staffing conflicts that cannot be resolved fairly within the team.
- Document the reason for any exception approval or denial in the HRIS notes field.

7.0 Exceptions and Escalation

Country-specific statutory leave, protected leave, and accommodation processes override this baseline where required by law. When a request intersects with a legal protection, managers must pause local interpretation and involve People Operations before confirming the final decision.

Escalations are required when leave conflicts affect customer commitments, repeat attendance patterns suggest a broader issue, or employees raise a concern about inconsistent policy application. The objective is to resolve issues through evidence and policy guidance rather than manager discretion alone.

8.0 Records and Review

The HRIS record is the official source for request status, dates, approvals, and manager notes. Supporting attachments, including required documentation for extended leave, should be stored according to retention and privacy requirements.

People Operations reviews leave utilization, approval timeliness, and year-end carryover data on a quarterly basis. Policy language is reviewed annually or sooner if local law, payroll processes, or business continuity requirements materially change.